

Cherish and the Charity Market

Vocabulary and Grammar Handout

Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

Cherish and Charity Market

Let's discuss a significant issue today — **be** content and cherish what you have.

At present, take a deep **breath** and **settle your** emotions with me; consider your own life —

I promise that your life is stable, safe, **lived** in comfort and plenty. If you refute **in** this way:

“No way, my life is really ordinary: daily work, countless hurdles and difficulties **turn** into monsters and **attack** me silently day and night.”

“**Exams**, frustration, **exhaustion** — my ideal life is to have countless money, live in a golden castle, always enjoying.....”

Everyone deserves to be well-fed and well-**clothed**, but in fact, the reality is: **the** large gap between poor and rich, **and** wealth inequality **leads** to vastly different levels of quality of life..... How can we fix this cruel problem? Have you ever **considered** this question carefully? If **not**, I invite you to discover this issue with me. **Let's** begin with my own experience, silent but indispensable:

To celebrate, my school always **organized** the “Charity **Market**” every **Children's Day**. Every class **had** to sell something and you **could** decide whether to donate or keep the money you **earned**. My group **decided** to make handmade snowflake Q cake together. Instead of taking the road we **were** sure of, we **chose** an uncertain path to **take**. Everyone **among** us **understood** that selling ice cream or fried instant noodles **would** definitely **guarantee** a stable income; however, we **chose** to be the unique one in the **whole** place.....

Luckily, heaven rewards **those** who persevere. The effort we **invested transformed** into countless **praise** and wealth from the customers, and we decided to **donate** all the money we earned to charity.....

Furthermore, a few days later, an exquisite letter **was** pressed under my desk mat. It **was** filled with **sentences** of gratitude and blessing. **Although** I don't know if the letter was really written by the charity or just a reward **from** teachers, **it is** the best feedback that I've **ever received**.

“Small gestures could offer the greatest blessing.” The last **sentence** of the letter is something that I’ll never forget.

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version improves clarity and flow while preserving the original voice and meaning.

Cherish and the Charity Market

Let us pause for a moment and reflect on something we often overlook — the simple act of being content with what we have.

Take a deep breath, quiet your mind, and consider your own life. Chances are, your life is stable, safe, and filled with comfort. Yet many of us would protest: “My life is nothing special — just endless work, with countless obstacles creeping up on me day and night,” or “Exams, frustration, exhaustion — my dream is to have unlimited wealth, live in a golden castle, and never worry again.”

Everyone deserves to be well-fed and well-clothed. However, the harsh reality is that the enormous gap between the rich and the poor leads to vastly different standards of living. How do we even begin to address such a deeply rooted problem? Have you ever pondered this question with care? If not, allow me to share my own small but meaningful experience.

Every year on Children’s Day, my school organized a charity market where each class had to sell something. Students could choose whether to donate the earnings or keep them. My group decided to make handmade snowflake Q cakes together. Rather than playing it safe and selling popular items like ice cream or fried instant noodles — which would have guaranteed a steady income — we ventured down an uncertain path, determined to stand out from the crowd.

Fortunately, perseverance paid off. The effort we poured into our project was rewarded with an overwhelming wave of compliments and support from customers. In the end, we donated every penny we earned to charity.

A few days later, I discovered an exquisite letter tucked beneath my desk mat. It was filled with heartfelt words of gratitude and blessing. To this day, I am still unsure whether the letter was truly written by someone from the charity or simply arranged by our teachers as encouragement — but either way, it remains the most touching feedback I have ever received.

“Small gestures can offer the greatest blessing.” That final line from the letter is something I will carry with me forever.

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition & Example from Text
1	overlook (v.)	to fail to notice or consider something. "Something we often overlook — the simple act of being content."
2	content (adj.)	satisfied and happy with what you have. "The simple act of being content with what we have."
3	protest (v.)	to express strong disagreement or objection. "Yet many of us would protest."
4	obstacle (n.)	something that blocks your way or makes progress difficult. "With countless obstacles creeping up on me day and night."
5	enormous (adj.)	extremely large in size or degree. "The enormous gap between the rich and the poor."
6	ponder (v.)	to think about something carefully and thoroughly. "Have you ever pondered this question with care?"
7	earnings (n.)	money received from work or sales. "Students could choose whether to donate the earnings or keep them."
8	guarantee (v.)	to make certain that something will happen. "Which would have guaranteed a steady income."
9	venture (v.)	to dare to do something risky or uncertain. "We ventured down an uncertain path."
10	perseverance (n.)	the quality of continuing to try despite difficulties. "Perseverance paid off."
11	overwhelming (adj.)	so great in amount or intensity that it is difficult to handle. "An overwhelming wave of compliments and support."
12	exquisite (adj.)	extremely beautiful or carefully made. "I discovered an exquisite letter tucked beneath my desk mat."

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. She was perfectly _____ with her small apartment and simple lifestyle.
a) enormous b) content c) overwhelming d) exquisite
2. The company cannot _____ that every product will be delivered on time.
a) ponder b) overlook c) guarantee d) venture
3. He tends to _____ small details, which often leads to bigger problems later.
a) overlook b) protest c) venture d) guarantee
4. The students _____ loudly when the teacher announced extra homework.
a) pondered b) overlooked c) ventured d) protested
5. Learning a new language requires patience and _____.
a) earnings b) perseverance c) obstacle d) protest
6. The _____ from the charity event were donated to a local hospital.
a) obstacles b) perseverance c) earnings d) ventures
7. She sat by the window and _____ her future career options.
a) guaranteed b) protested c) pondered d) overlooked
8. Few people are willing to _____ into unfamiliar territory without preparation.
a) ponder b) protest c) overlook d) venture
9. The jewelry box was _____, with delicate carvings on every surface.
a) enormous b) overwhelming c) exquisite d) content
10. The amount of support they received from the community was _____.
a) content b) exquisite c) enormous d) overwhelming

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box.

overlook obstacle enormous ponder venture perseverance

1. The biggest _____ to finishing the project was the lack of funding.
2. It is easy to _____ the importance of sleep when you are busy with work.
3. She spent the whole evening _____ whether to accept the job offer.
4. His success was the result of years of hard work and _____.
5. The _____ size of the stadium amazed all the visitors.
6. After months of planning, they finally decided to _____ into the restaurant business.

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: “Determined + to verb”

Form: Subject + verb, determined + to verb

Use: To express a strong resolve or firm decision to do something.

Example from text: *“We ventured down an uncertain path, determined to stand out from the crowd.”*

More examples:

- She stayed up all night, determined to finish the report before the deadline.
- He signed up for the marathon, determined to prove himself.
- They moved to a new city, determined to start a better life.

Pattern 2: “Whether... or...” for alternatives

Form: whether + to verb / clause + or + verb / clause

Use: To present two possible choices or options.

Example from text: *“Students could choose whether to donate the earnings or keep them.”*

More examples:

- I haven’t decided whether to study abroad or stay here.
- She wondered whether the gift was handmade or bought from a store.
- It doesn’t matter whether you win or lose — what counts is your effort.

Pattern 3: “To this day” for something that continues from the past

Form: To this day, subject + verb (present tense)

Use: To emphasize that something from the past still continues or remains true now.

Example from text: *“To this day, I am still unsure whether the letter was truly written by someone from the charity.”*

More examples:

- To this day, she remembers every word of her grandmother’s advice.
- To this day, no one knows who left the mysterious package at the door.
- To this day, that song still brings tears to my eyes.

Pattern 4: “Either way” as a connector

Form: Either way, subject + verb

Use: To say that the result or conclusion is the same regardless of which option is true.

Example from text: *“Either way, it remains the most touching feedback I have ever received.”*

More examples:

- You can take the bus or the train. Either way, you’ll arrive by noon.
- I’m not sure if he forgot or chose not to come. Either way, I was disappointed.
- She might accept or reject the offer. Either way, we need a backup plan.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. She left the country, _____ to never look back.
a) determine b) determined c) determining d) determination
2. I can’t decide _____ to accept the offer or wait for a better one.
a) that b) if c) whether d) which
3. _____, the smell of freshly baked bread reminds her of her childhood.
a) Until today b) From that day c) To this day d) Since this day
4. We could fly or take the train. _____, the trip will take most of the day.
a) However b) Either way c) Otherwise d) In contrast
5. He walked into the interview room, _____ to make a strong impression.
a) determines b) determine c) to determine d) determined
6. She hasn’t decided _____ she wants to major in art or music.
a) whether b) that c) what d) how
7. The restaurant may be expensive or affordable. _____, the food is excellent.
a) In contrast b) Either way c) Otherwise d) On the other hand
8. _____, nobody has been able to explain what happened that night.
a) In the past b) From now on c) To this day d) At that time

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite the following sentences using the grammar pattern indicated.

1. She quit her job and started her own business. She was resolved to follow her dream.
(Use: determined + to verb)

→ _____

2. He enrolled in a cooking class. He was resolved to improve his skills. (Use: determined + to verb)

→ _____

3. I don't know if I should take the job or continue studying. (Use: whether... or...)

→ _____

4. He is thinking about two options: save the money or invest it. (Use: whether... or...)

→ _____

5. She heard that song twenty years ago and it still makes her cry. (Use: To this day)

→ _____

6. He made a mistake ten years ago and still regrets it. (Use: To this day)

→ _____

7. Maybe the weather will be sunny, or maybe it will rain. We will enjoy the picnic no matter what. (Use: Either way)

→ _____

8. The movie might be a comedy or a drama. I want to watch it regardless. (Use: Either way)

→ _____

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) content 2. c) guarantee 3. a) overlook 4. d) protested 5. b) perseverance 6. c) earnings 7. c) pondered 8. d) venture 9. c) exquisite 10. d) overwhelming

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. obstacle 2. overlook 3. pondering 4. perseverance 5. enormous 6. venture

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) determined 2. c) whether 3. c) To this day 4. b) Either way 5. d) determined 6. a) whether 7. b) Either way 8. c) To this day

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. She quit her job and started her own business, determined to follow her dream.
2. He enrolled in a cooking class, determined to improve his skills.
3. I can't decide whether to take the job or continue studying.
4. He is thinking about whether to save the money or invest it.
5. To this day, that song still makes her cry.
6. To this day, he still regrets the mistake he made ten years ago.
7. The weather might be sunny or rainy. Either way, we will enjoy the picnic.
8. The movie might be a comedy or a drama. Either way, I want to watch it.